

Escalation Support for Managers



Why this happens: Educators rarely say when they are overwhelmed. They usually just say "I'm fine." However, an educator carrying high stress into a room will react faster to minor friction, triggering room tension before the morning even gets moving.

Try This:

Watch physical cues at shift start, such as rushed movements, heavy sighs, or quiet withdrawal. Offer for them to grab a fresh glass of water before the kids arrive, or ask "Do you want me to get you a cold face washer?"

What physical cues showed you which room needed extra practical support before the morning rush?

Rung 1 of 10
Shift Start Check-In

Escalation Support for Managers



Why this happens: When a room gets chaotic, leaders often try to fix child behavior first. In reality, harsh lighting, background noise, or cramped space usually triggered the chaos in the first place.

Try This:

Look at the room setup before you look at the children. Dim overhead fluorescent lights, open a window for fresh air, or clear a doorway bottleneck before trying to correct a child.

What environmental change lowered the sensory load in your rooms today?

Rung 2 of 10
Environmental Eyes First

Escalation Support for Managers



Why this happens: Directors get used to hearing high room volume all day. However, constant noise acts as a silent drain on sensitive children and educators, causing sudden meltdowns over minor things.

Try This:

Walk into a room, pause, and close your eyes for five seconds. Listen for background echo, blaring music, or overlapping chatter. Turn off background speakers or move loud active play outside to drop the noise pressure instantly.

Did you notice any background noise that was draining staff or children without anyone realising it?

Rung 3 of 10

Noise Desensitisation Trap

Escalation Support for Managers



Why this happens: Managers naturally enter rooms to check on safety or lend support. However, standing upright in a doorway can unintentionally look like an inspection, which makes educators feel watched and tense.

Try This:

Lower your physical height as soon as you step inside. Crouch down near the edge of the room, speak quietly, or pick up a simple hands on job like gathering toys or refilling water jugs. This signals to staff that you're there to help.

What soft posture or simple task helped staff feel supported when you walked into their room today?

Rung 4 of 10
Stepping In Softly

Escalation Support for Managers



Why this happens: Staff rooms are often filled with paper clutter, harsh overhead lighting, or administrative notices, keeping stress high. When educators spend their break in an intense space, they return to the floor without actually resetting their energy.

Try This:

Turn the staff room into a genuine sensory reset space. Replace harsh fluorescent lighting with a warm table lamp, clear clutter off the table, and keep cold water or herbal tea ready so staff can truly unwind before returning to the floor.

What simple change in your staff room helped educators recharge during their breaks today?

Rung 5 of 10
The Staff Room Reset

Escalation Support for Managers



Why this happens: When educators feel burnt out, keeping them in high noise indoor spaces only worsens their stress. Giving staff autonomy to choose a physically grounding task lets their nervous system settle while keeping them actively involved.

Try This:

Give staff the choice to swap into a regulating task when room pressure rises. Let them step outside to water the garden, sweep the outdoor patio deck, restock the tea station, or prep sensory bins away from the noise.

What regulating job choice helped an educator reset their energy today?

Rung 6 of 10
Regulating Job Choices

Escalation Support for Managers



Why this happens: Parents often arrive at pick up carrying their own build up of stress from work or traffic. Walking into a foyer with bright fluorescent lighting and buzzing noise keeps their stress high, which children absorb instantly during handovers.

Try This:

Create a sensory soothing front entrance. Place potted jasmine or chamomile near the doorway, set up an icy cold water station or takeaway tea cart, and swap harsh overhead lights for warm lamps so families can catch their breath as soon as they step inside.

How did creating a calmer front entry change the energy during drop offs or afternoon pick ups?

Rung 7 of 10

Calming the Front Door

Escalation Support for Managers



Why this happens: Rushed pick up times force staff and parents to talk over loud room noise about incident reports or hard moments. This leaves parents feeling defensive and anxious before they even reach the car.

Try This:

Set up a quiet, low lit seating nook near the front foyer for delicate conversations. Offer parents a glass of cold water or tea, let them sit down, and share one moment of sensory connection or progress their child had during the day before discussing challenges.

What small adjustment to your handover space helped parents feel supported instead of rushed today?

Rung 8 of 10
Soft Parent Handovers

Escalation Support for Managers



Why this happens: When a major meltdown or incident happens, debriefs often slide into compliance checks or blame. Looking only at child behaviour or staff error misses the sensory triggers that built up long before the event occurred.

Try This:

Shift post incident debriefs toward sensory and room conditions. Ask the educator what the room felt like leading up to the moment. Look together at background noise levels, room temperature, transition bottlenecks, or visual overload that pushed the space past its limit.

What environmental factor came up during your debrief that can be changed to support your team?

Rung 9 of 10
Incident Debriefs

Escalation Support for Managers



Why this happens: Managers spend all day absorbing pressure from families, staff, and children. Trying to calm a high stress environment when your own tank is completely empty leads to rushed decisions and sudden burnout.

Try This:

Find your own fast sensory reset before stepping into room challenges or difficult conversations. Take two minutes outside in the fresh air, drink a cold glass of water, or focus on a quiet corner to steady your own body energy first.

What personal reset moment helped you stay grounded before supporting your team today?

Rung 10 of 10
Your Anchor